

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Engineer | Incident Response and Threat Monitoring Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience in cyber security engineering, incident response, threat monitoring, and vulnerability management across Windows Server and Azure cloud environments. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, Single Sign-On (SSO), and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Group Policy administration. I have led multiple incident response investigations, built detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, managed enterprise vulnerability management programmes, and evaluated and implemented security enhancements across large-scale Microsoft infrastructure environments. I work closely with infrastructure operations and technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and continually strengthen an organisation's overall security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk, KQL-based detection rule development, MITRE ATT&CK aligned threat hunting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR (M365), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response framework, forensic analysis, containment and eradication, post-incident review, business email compromise (BEC) and ransomware response
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, vulnerability assessment, risk prioritisation, remediation tracking
- **Windows Server and Azure Infrastructure:** Windows Server 2016/2019/2022, Active Directory (AD), DNS, Group Policy, Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, PKI management
- **MDM and Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Group Policy, device compliance enforcement
- **Identity and Access Management:** Entra Identity, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO federation, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Kusto Query Language (KQL), Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer March 2025 - Present

- Own security controls and security architecture across an 8,000-user enterprise estate, working closely with infrastructure operations and technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and strengthen the organisation's overall security posture
- Lead incident response investigations using Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI), conducting forensic analysis, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting following NIST 800-61
- Build and maintain KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, improving threat hunting coverage and reducing mean time to detect threats
- Monitor emerging threats and evaluate, test, and recommend security enhancements and controls to continually improve the firm's security posture
- Identify, assess, and remediate vulnerabilities across Windows Server and Azure cloud infrastructure using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams

- Manage Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO configurations, and certificate (PKI) management across enterprise applications
- Administer Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance across Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android platforms
- Develop security awareness and business continuity capabilities, delivering training to staff and running phishing simulation exercises
- Lead Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development using PowerShell and KQL, automating repetitive security operations tasks
- Remediate penetration test findings, prioritising and tracking remediation of critical and high-risk vulnerabilities in coordination with the infrastructure and application teams

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, performing end-to-end triage, escalation, and incident documentation
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment and policy configuration across an 8,000-user estate, integrating MDE data into Sentinel for unified threat detection
- Administered Entra Identity (Azure AD) Group Policy, Conditional Access, and MFA rollout, reducing identity-related security risks and supporting SSO integrations
- Supported vulnerability management activities using Tenable Nessus, identifying, prioritising, and tracking remediation of vulnerabilities across Windows Server and cloud infrastructure
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, managing privileged credentials, session recording, and least-privilege access enforcement
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM and supervised endpoint compliance reporting across the device estate
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate security event correlation, compliance reporting, and routine security operations tasks
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus audit preparation, gap analysis, evidence collection, and remediation of identified findings

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Deployed and configured endpoint security, email security gateways, and identity management platforms to secure a SaaS FinTech environment built on Azure and Windows Server infrastructure
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) MFA, SSO, and Conditional Access policies, improving identity security and access governance
- Maintained Windows Server environments including Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and Group Policy, ensuring security hardening and compliance with security standards
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM and enforced device compliance policies across the organisation's endpoint estate
- Conducted vulnerability assessments, monitored emerging threats, and coordinated vendor remediation for identified security weaknesses
- Supported ISO 27001 information security management system documentation, internal audit preparation, and risk register maintenance

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment across an 8,000-user enterprise estate, delivering policy configuration, exclusion management, and full integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified threat detection
- Built KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel that improved MITRE ATT&CK technique coverage and significantly enhanced threat hunting and incident response capability
- Delivered multiple successful incident response investigations including advanced persistent threat (APT) containment, business email compromise (BEC), and ransomware incident response
- Designed and implemented a vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentra BAS, achieving measurable reduction in critical vulnerability exposure across Windows Server and Azure cloud

infrastructure

- Managed Microsoft Entra Identity Conditional Access and MFA rollout across the organisation, strengthening identity security and reducing account takeover risk
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, managing the complete evidence collection, gap remediation, and assessor liaison process

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)